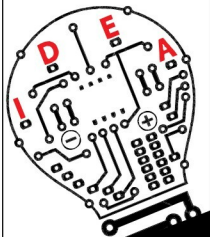


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DO-IT-YOURSELF

Open Windows Task Manager Services to make sure both Bonjour-service and KinoniSvc are running. If not, start these by right-clicking and choosing Start Service. If you do not see Bonjour-service or KinoniSvc, please reinstall the required Windows drivers.

Check firewall settings. Your firewall application can block the traffic between PC and phone. If you use Windows firewall, Kinoni Barcode Reader Windows installer will automatically configure it to allow traffic.

If you are using third-party firewall software like Norton or F-Secure, configure these to allow Bonjour-service traffic on UDP port 5353. Also allow KinoniSvc to accept incoming connections to TCP port 5055.

Settings in Android app

In App Settings (Figs 4 and 5), we can select Connection Type as Wi-Fi or Bluetooth. After selecting Bluetooth, select the paired device by tapping Bluetooth (not at check box).

There is an option for selecting 1D barcodes, QR codes, data matrix and the like. We can set to beep or vibrate or both when a code is scanned.

There is option for flash LED settings when scanning a barcode. Other options available are invert colours and others. These options are for Barcode Reader and QR Scanner app only, and other apps may have different options.

This method of using Android smartphone as a barcode scanner is very useful for students, small business owners and hobbyists for various applications that require barcode reading work. Using this method, they can directly insert barcode data at the cursor location in Windows PC, which is very useful to insert barcode data in MS Excel and inventory management applications. This method may not act as a replacement for an actual physical barcode reader, but is very useful for less-demanding barcode scanning.

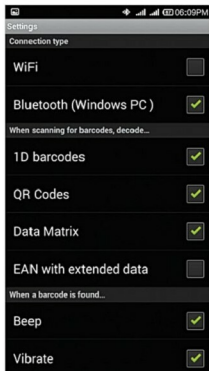


Fig. 5: Xiaomi Redmi 1S screenshot

There are issues with certain mobile phones when using these as barcode scanners. This app has been tested in EFY Labs using Samsung Galaxy (Xiaomi Red MI 1S smart phone has been used by author) and the barcode scanning and Windows PC data appeared at the cursor location perfectly.

Some hardware may not be compatible with this application and the app may not function. The camera in a smartphone without Auto Focus may not be able to read the barcode accurately. But it is good for scanning barcode in places where there is good light.

There are certain apps available in Google Play Store that require setting COM Port in Windows PC for connection with Bluetooth. The app used in this article can send data using Bluetooth without setting COM port. **EFY**



Madhuram Mishra is a student of ME digital communication at NITTTT, Bhopal